

Dominic Le

Contact

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[GitHub](#), [Webpage](#)

Research Interests

Causation, counterfactuals, cognitive development, computational cognitive science, learning, memory, philosophy of language, philosophy of cognitive science.

Education

M.A in Developmental Psychology and Education.
University of Toronto, Canada

2026 - 2027

H.B.Sc. in Psychology and Cognitive Science (Computational),
University of Toronto, Canada

2022 - 2026

Ongoing Research

Backwards Counterfactual Reasoning in Children and Adults
Supervisor: Ioana Grosu & Patricia Ganea, University of Toronto.
Department of Applied Psychology and Human Development.

Sep 2024 –

Hierarchical Models of Associative Learning
Supervisor: Sara Aronowitz, University of Toronto.
Department of Philosophy.

Aug 2024 –

Modelling Causal Reasoning in a Cognitive Architecture
Supervisor: Can Mekik, University of Toronto.
Department of Psychology.

Sep 2024 –

Publications

Ioana Grosu, **Dominic Le**, Patricia Ganea (2025). *Backwards Counterfactuals and the Closest Possible World*. Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society. Vol. 47. 2025. <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/0q93p7sc>

Conferences & Presentations

Refereed

Dominic Le, Ioana Grosu, & Patricia Ganea (2026, April). *Children's Backward Counterfactual Logic*. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Bi-Ennial Conference (CDS 2026), Montreal, QC.

Dominic Le (2025). *Causal Stacks: A Structural Framework for Recurrent and Hierarchical Counterfactual Reasoning*. Presented as poster for the 5th European Experimental Philosophy Conference, Norwich, UK; the Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP 2025) Annual Meeting; and the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2025).

Ioana Grosu, **Dominic Le**, & Patricia Ganea (2025, July). *Backwards Counterfactuals and the Closest Possible World*. Talk presented at CogSci 2025, San Francisco, CA.

Ioana Grosu, **Dominic Le**, & Patricia Ganea (2025, June). *Changes to Models of Reality in Backwards Counterfactual Reasoning*. Poster presented at the 51st Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP 2025), Ithaca, NY.

Student

	Dominic Le, Can Mekik (2026, April). <i>How Search Strategies Explain Directional Asymmetries in Causal Reasoning</i>. Talk presented at the Psychology Undergraduate Research Community (PURC) Student Symposium, Toronto, ON. Dominic Le, Ioana Grosu, & Patricia Ganea (2025, February). <i>Time's Asymmetry in Counterfactuals</i>. Talk presented at the Cognitive Science and Artificial Intelligence Student Association (CASA) Undergraduate Conference, Toronto, ON. Dominic Le (2024, September). <i>Modeling Children's Development of Modal Thought</i>. Talk presented at the Collective Undergraduate Research (CURE) Flash Talks, Toronto, ON. Dominic Le, Oksana Tkachman (2024, March). <i>Spatial Frames of Reference in Signed Languages</i>. Talk presented at the Western Interdisciplinary Student Symposium on Language Research (WISSLR), London, ON.	
Software	Quentin Dercon, Rina Harsch, Dominic Le, Shannon Yasuda, Cherrie Chang, Melissa Struhl (2025). <i>snap-sort (Version 1.0.0)</i> [Software]. In review for jsPsych-contrib. https://github.com/DomDaSquishyBomb/plugin-drag-and-drop	
Labwork	Research Assistant, Cognitive Development Jan 2024 – PI: Ioana Grosu & Patricia Ganea, University of Toronto Language & Learning Lab Research Assistant, Psycholinguistics Mar 2023 –Sep 2024 PI: Oksana Tkachman, University of British Columbia Language & Learning Lab Research Assistant, Morality and Abnormal Psychology Nov 2023 –Jun 2024 PI: Mark Miller, University of Toronto Consciousness & Wisdom Studies Lab	
Previous Employment	Child's Program Assistant, UofT Family Housing Jun 2024 –Aug 2024 Supported Child Care Worker, BGC Canada Jun 2023 –Sep 2023 Day Camp Coordinator, Cadets Canada Jun 2022 –Aug 2022	
Relevant Coursework	<u>Programming & Computer Science:</u> Data, Computation, and the Mind: Python Software Design: Java <u>Psychology & Cognitive Science:</u> Behavioural Neuroscience Sensation and Perception Intro to Philosophy: Knowledge and Reality Intro to Developmental Psychology <u>Statistics & Mathematics:</u> Experimental Design and Theory: R Psychology Statistics II: JASP Probability and Statistics I: R Linear Algebra	Seminar on Cognitive Architectures: Python Intro to A.I.: Python Intro to Computer Programming: Python Minds and Machines Semantic Theory Intro to Cognitive Science Intro to Psychology Intro to Cognitive Psychology Treatment of Psychological Data: R Math Expres. and Reas. in Computer Science Probability and Statistics II: R Multivariable Calculus with Proofs Calculus with Proofs

Student Affiliations	Editor , Mentis - UofT Cognitive Science Undergraduate Journal	2024 –
	Mentor , CURE - Undergraduate Research Student Group	2024 –
	Staff Writer , Demo Magazine - Hart House Music Publication	2023 - 2024
	Executive Secretary , CASA - CogSci and A.I. Student Association	2024 –2025
	CogSci Course Union Representative , University College Council	2024 –2025
Awards & Scholarships	(\$7500) University of Toronto Research Excellence Award (UTEA-SSH).	2026
	University of Toronto Student Leadership Award.	2026
	(\$7500) University of Toronto Research Excellence Award (UTEA-SSH).	2025
	(\$1500) Victoria College Regents Participation Award.	2025
	(Priceless) MAT237 Meme Contest Nominee. x2	2024
	(\$2000) Gyro Club of Nanaimo Jack Ryan Scholarship.	2022
	(\$1250) British Columbia District/Authority Scholarship.	2022
	(\$1250) British Columbia Excellence Scholarship.	2022
Travel Awards	(\$2000) Vancouver Island University Dual Enrollment Scholarship.	2021
	(\$1000) Susan Macdonald Award.	2025
	(\$500) Dr. Roseann Runte Award.	2025
	(\$250) ASSU Travel Grant.	2025
	(\$150) SPP Travel Award.	2025
Skills & Characteristics	<u>Natural Languages:</u>	Fluent: English (native), French. Rudimentary: Vietnamese (first-learned).
	<u>Computer Languages:</u>	Proficient: R, Python, Java, HTML/CSS Rudimentary: JavaScript, C#, C++.
	<u>Certifications:</u>	Standard First Aid - with CPR-C-AED (St. John Ambulance till 2026), Responsible Adult (YMCA, 2023)
	<u>Software Tools:</u>	Document-preparation: MS Office, LaTeX (Overleaf/VSCode), Google Workspace. Data-collection: Qualtrics, MTurk, ChildrenHelpingScience, REDCap, jsPsych. Data-processing: RStudio, Pandas+NumPy, JASP. Image-manipulation: Photoshop, Canva Audio-editing: Ableton Live, Logic, Audacity. Video-editing: Premiere, Final Cut, Animate.
	<u>Outside Interests:</u>	Songwriting and role-playing video games.